

Guidance

How to open and view “shapefile” maps of forest land

June 2022

Sometimes when we process applications to register post-1989 forest land in the ETS, we find some land is not eligible. When this happens, we create two digital maps (called shapefiles) to show which part of the land is eligible, and which part is not. We provide these to you when we have finished processing your application.

This guide explains how to open and view these digital maps on your computer. It is intended to support people who are not familiar with digital mapping or shapefiles.

DISCLAIMER: Reference in this guidance to a specific commercial or third party product, process, or service, whether by trade or company name, trademark or otherwise, including 7-Zip and Google Earth, does not constitute an endorsement or recommendation by the New Zealand Government or the Ministry for Primary Industries.

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- the accuracy or content of material in this Guidance
- any person relying on this Guidance and suffering any form of loss

You use this Guidance at your own risk.

Step 1 Save and unzip the files attached to your email

You will find two files attached to the email containing the decision about your application to register forest land into the ETS (officially, we call this decision a “final assessment”). The two files will have names ending in “.zip”.

- Save these files onto your computer.
- The files in the email are zipped (compressed). This makes them smaller and suitable to be emailed. The files are zipped using a programme called 7-Zip. Even if you don’t have 7-Zip installed, your computer should be able to open these files if it has Windows.
- Double click on the file and your computer should either:
 - open the folder and allow you to move and save the files elsewhere, or
 - prompt you to ask where you would like to extract and save the files.
- Save the files in a new folder on your computer. Each zipped file should contain eight files ending in: “.cpg”, “.dbf”, “.prj”, “.sbn”, “.sbx”, “.shp”, “.shp” and “.shx”.
- If this doesn’t work and you can’t open the “.zip” file and see these files, consider downloading the 7-Zip programme. This is available to download for free: <https://www.7-zip.org/>

Once saved, the eight files in each shapefile together contain the information for a digital map of the forest land. It is important to extract them from the zipped files and save them somewhere else because otherwise you may not be able to open or view them in the next steps.

Step 2 Download and install the free software, Google Earth Pro

Google Earth Pro is software that will allow you to view the shapefile maps of the land in your ETS application. These shapefiles show which land is and isn't eligible to join the ETS.

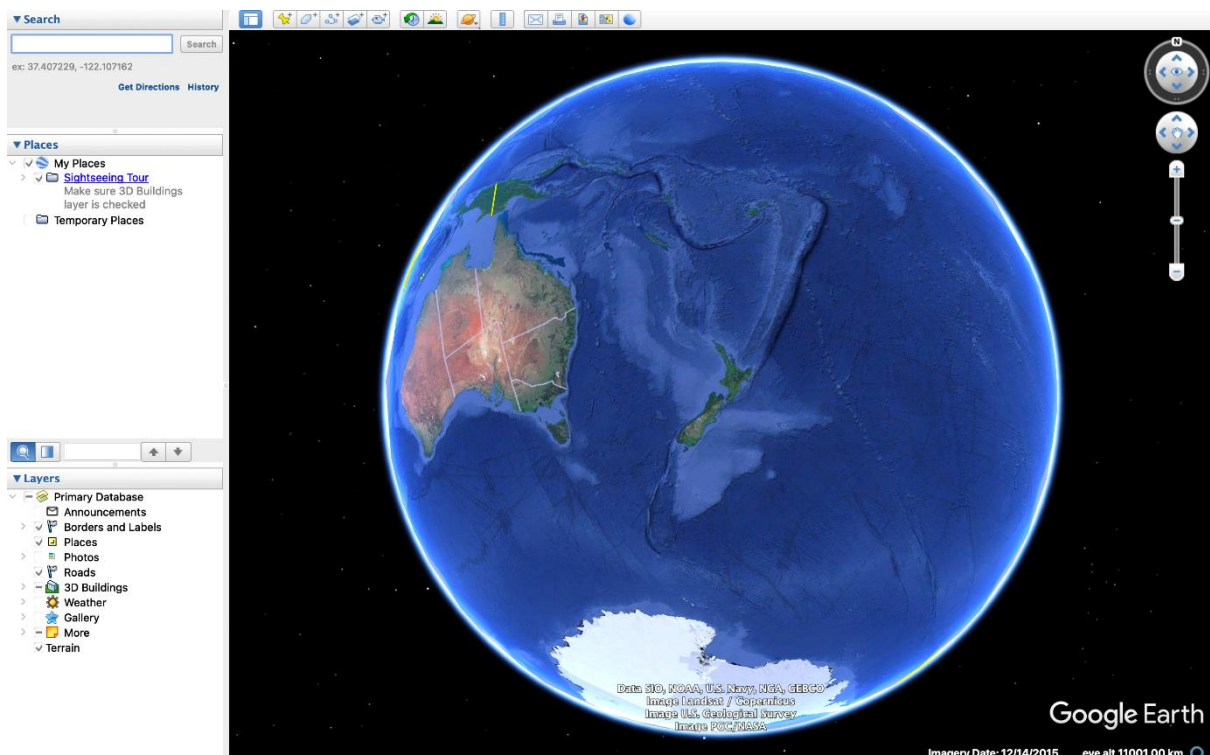
You can also view recent and older satellite images of your land on Google Earth Pro.

- To download Google Earth Pro on your computer, use this web link:
<https://www.google.com/earth/versions/#download-pro>
- Follow the prompts that appear in the web browser. You will be asked to accept some terms and conditions and to download a file. The name of the file will be:
 - GoogleEarthProSetup.exe if you are on a PC
 - GoogleEarthProMac-Intel.dmg if your computer is a Mac.
- To install Google Earth Pro on your computer, double click on the downloaded file and a window will pop up called "Install Google Earth".
- Follow the instructions to install Google Earth Pro.

Step 3 Viewing the maps of your forest land

Load the shapefile maps into Google Earth Pro

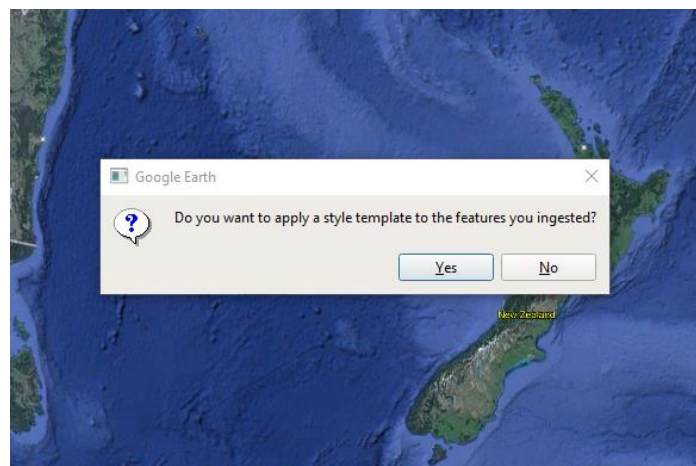
- Open Google Earth Pro (it may open automatically after you have installed it). It should look similar to the image below.



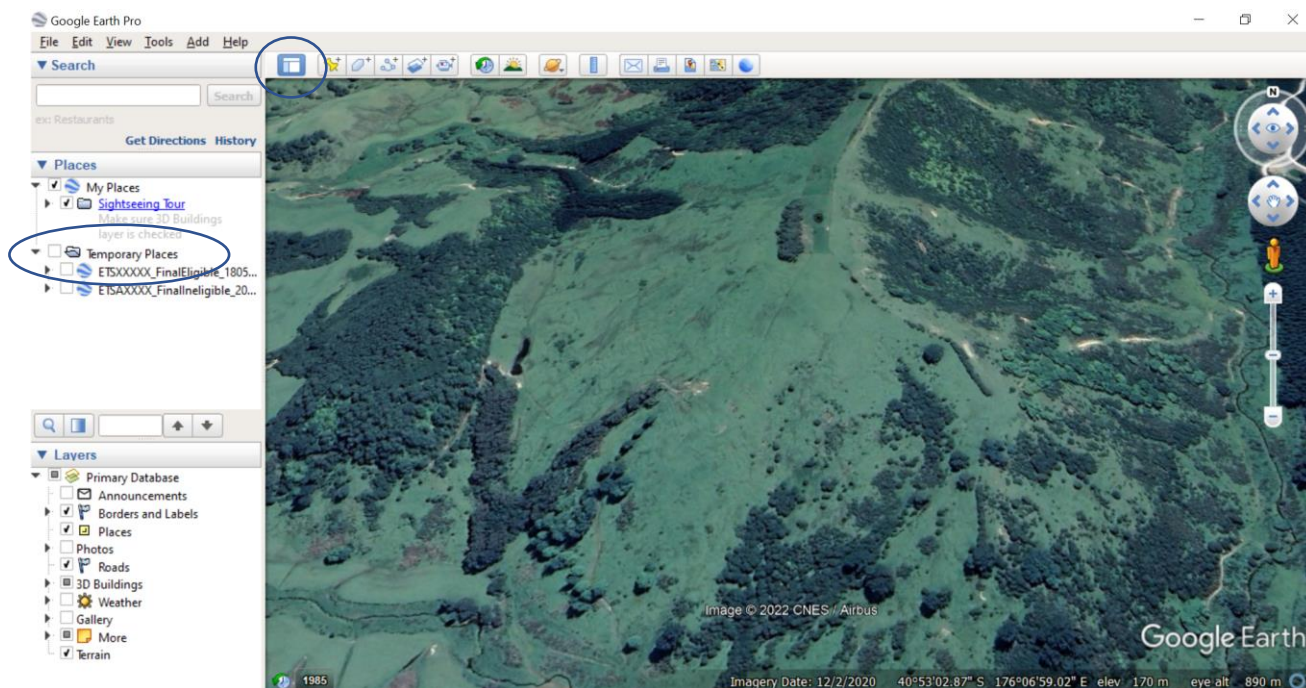
- Open the folder where you saved the shapefile files.
- Drag and drop the file that is a “SHP file” type (see image below) onto the map shown in Google Earth Pro. If the folder isn’t showing these details, change the view in the folder to show the details (if on a PC, right-hand click in the folder, select “View” from the menu that pops up, and “Details”).
- There will be two SHP files and you need to drag both across.
 - one for the land that we assessed is eligible to register in the ETS. This will be in the folder named “Final Eligible Shapefile- CCIS”.
 - one for the land that we assessed is not eligible to join. This will be in the folder named “Final Ineligible Shapefile”

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:37 AM	CPG File	1 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:37 AM	DBF File	1 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:36 AM	PRJ File	1 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:36 AM	SBN File	1 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:36 AM	SBX File	1 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:37 AM	SHP File	2 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:37 AM	XML Document	584 KB
ETSA...	29/04/2022 9:37 AM	SHX File	1 KB

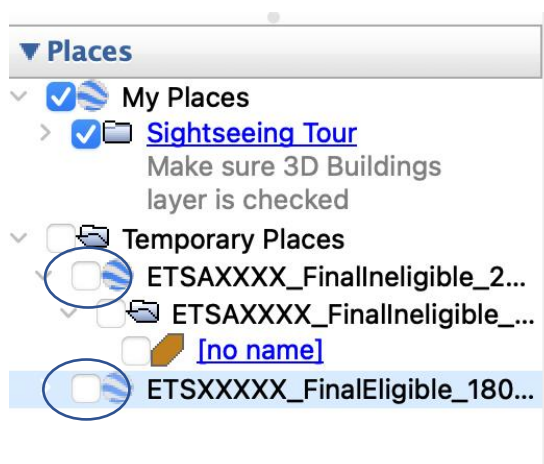
- When you drag and drop the files, Google Earth will ask: “Do you want to apply a style template to the features you ingested?” (see image below). Select “No”.
- When you drag and drop the files into Google Earth, the view should automatically zoom to where the shapefiles are located on your land. If not, double click in the centre of the map and it should zoom in and take you there.
- You won’t be able to see the shapefiles straight away. The next steps will explain how to make them appear.



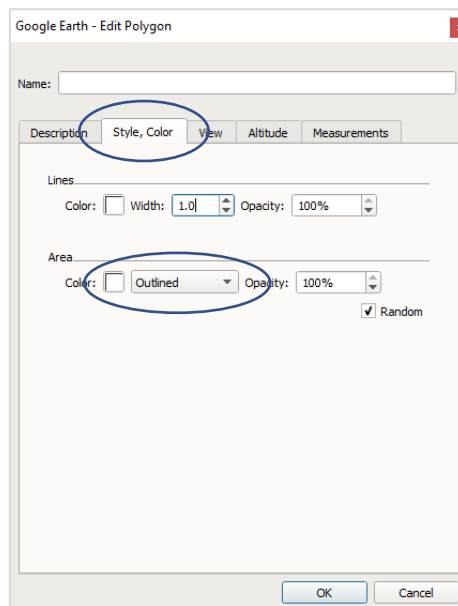
How to view the maps



- On the left-hand side of the Google Earth window, you should see a panel named “Places”. If you can’t see the panel, click the small tool in the top bar (shown in the image above).
- Your shapefiles will be listed under “Temporary Places” (marked in image above, in Places panel). If you can’t see both files there, try dragging them across from their folder on to the Google Earth window again.
- To display the shapefiles, click the box to the left of the file name (see below).



- When you first display shapefiles in Google Map, they are given random colours and are filled in. To be able to see your land, it’s better to make them transparent:
 - **If your computer is a PC**, use your right-hand mouse button to click on one of the shapefiles. Select “Properties” from the menu that appears and a new window will pop up (image below).
 - **If your computer is a Mac**, click on one of the shapefiles and select “Get info” from the menu that pops up. A similar window below will appear.



- Click on the “Style, Color” tab to change the styling of the shapefiles. For example, you might like to make the inside transparent so that you can see the land through it.
- Under the section called “Area”, select “Outlined” from the drop-down menu instead of “Filled+Outlined”.
- You can also change the colour and thickness of the border line under the section called “Lines”. For example, you could colour the border lines of the eligible and ineligible land differently to tell them apart.

You should now be able to see the areas of the land in your ETS application that we assessed are and aren’t presently eligible to register in the ETS.

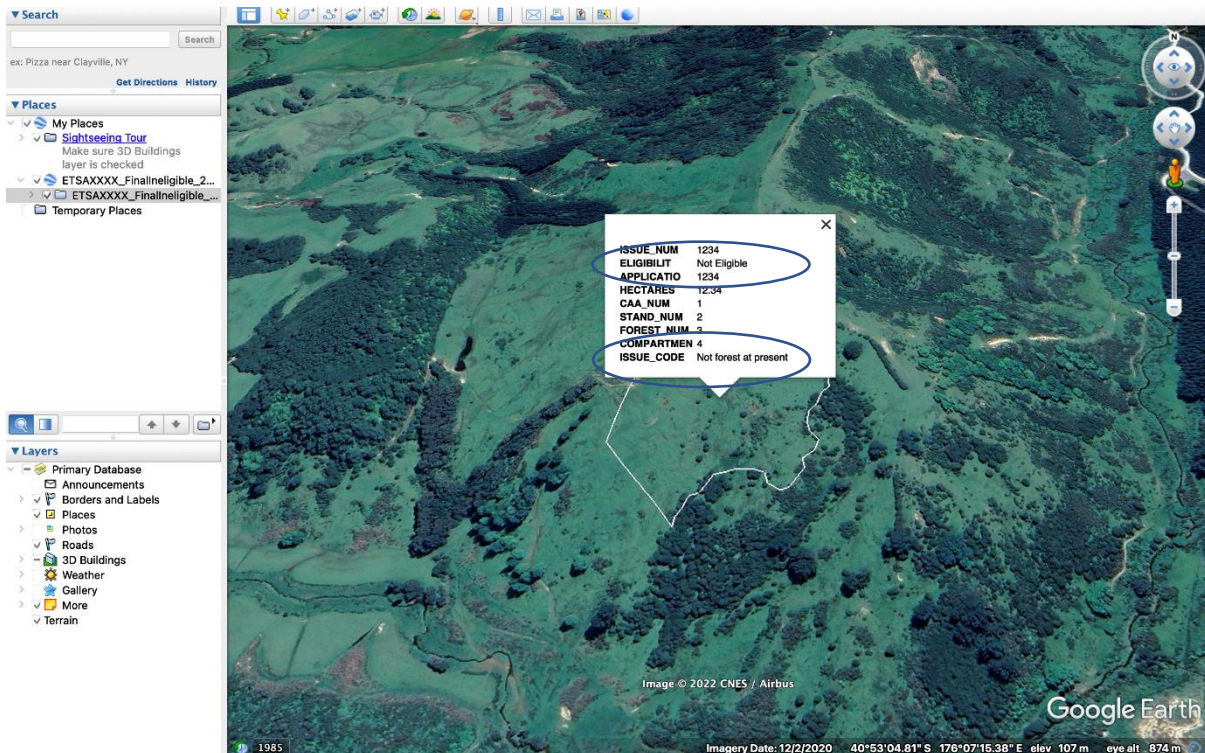
Navigating in the map

If you have used other online interactive maps, the way you move around in Google Earth Pro is similar. Use the mouse wheel (if you have one) to move in and out. Hold the left side of your mouse to drag the map and scroll across.

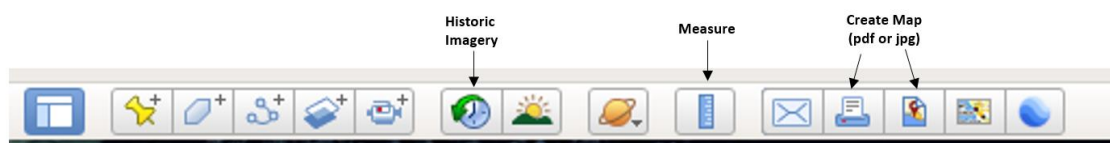
There are also tools to help you on the right-hand side of the image. If these are not showing, select “View” at the top of the window then “Show Navigation” and then tick the ‘Automatically’ button. This displays tools in the top right-hand corner to use for navigating your way around the map.

Step 4 See why your land is not eligible

- Click on each area to view more details in a pop-up box (image below shows shapefile of land that was not eligible)
- To see why we assessed that the land is not eligible, click on areas of ineligible land (left-hand click if you are on a PC), and look for the reason next to “ISSUE_CODE”.



Other ways to use Google Earth for viewing your land



- You can view older satellite images to see how the forest cover changed over time by clicking the **Historic Imagery** button at the top of the window. A time slider will display in the upper-left corner of the map. This shows the available older images and when they were taken. (Note: MPI uses other imagery to assess the eligibility of your land to join the ETS. We have access to much more data when making our decisions.)
- You can measure distance and area on the map using the **Measure** button. Clicking this will display a pop-up box. You can select different types of measurement and change the units. Click on the map to place point to measure. You can save these to your map or clear the measurement.
- Use **Create Map** buttons to save the map as a PDF or JPG file. Clicking these buttons displays a pop-up tool for adding and removing information to your map, and for editing.
- If you want your ETS application shapefiles to show when you open Google Earth Pro next time, go to the “Places” panel on the left-hand side of the screen. Drag your files out of “Temporary Places” into “My Places” (see image above).

For more information

Forestry in the Emissions Trading Scheme – MPI website:

<https://www.mpi.govt.nz/forestry/forestry-in-the-emissions-trading-scheme/>

Who to contact

If you have questions about forestry in the ETS:

- email climatechange@mpi.govt.nz
- call 0800 CLIMATE (0800 25 46 28) and select option 2.